

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

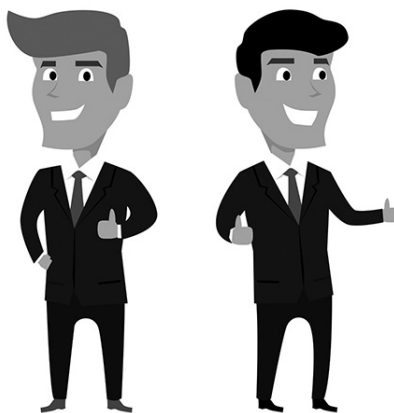
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Let's Start!

Let's take a look at some important information about the competitor.



Learning Outcome

Accurately use important information about people's jobs and places of work in communicative situations.

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about jobs and work.
- I can agree and disagree.
- I can give my opinion.

Ask your partner:

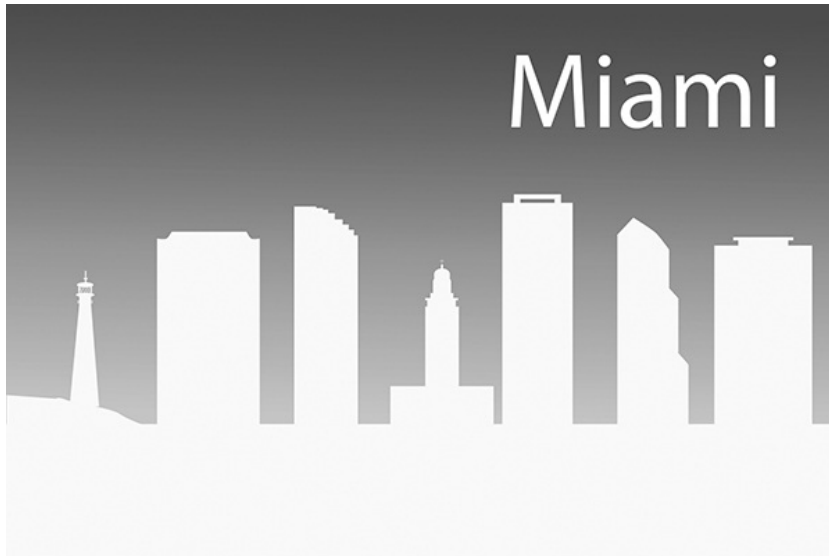
- What do you say when you agree with someone?
- What about when you disagree with someone?





Let's Explore!

Miranda and Janet continue with their meeting about their competitor.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Janet:** Okay, so in order for us to implement our strategy, I need to make sure you're in the loop, Miranda.
- Miranda:** So do I. What else do you know about them?
- Janet:** Well, as I've mentioned, the Garcia Partners are an e-commerce company based in the States. The company was founded 10 years ago by cousins Daniel and Margot Garcia.
- Miranda:** To my mind, if they're based in Miami, it doesn't mean they have an advantage over us. Would you agree with that, Janet?
- Janet:** Not necessarily. Their headquarters are located in Miami, Florida, but they have offices in Latin America.
- Miranda:** I can see your point now. However, we seem to have some Spanish and Portuguese-speaking staff. Wouldn't you agree that this can give us a leg up?
- Janet:** I don't disagree with that, but, as far as I know, Daniel Garcia, VP of Sales, has a workforce made up of 10 sales people, all of whom are based in Argentina and Brazil. They speak English, Spanish and Portuguese.
- Miranda:** Hmmm. I believe this will give them a huge advantage. We've got more staff, but we've only got 3 people who can actually speak both Spanish and Portuguese.
- Janet:** That's a good point. But we need to bear in mind we have other strengths. Let's just call it a day and have Peter set up an appointment with Mr. Farmani.





Let's Practice!

Does Janet agree or disagree with Miranda?

Instructions: Read the statement. Select the correct answer.

- | | |
|--|---|
| <p>1. Would you agree with that, Janet? Janet doesn't agree, she says...</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> a. I'm sure you're right. b. Not necessarily. c. That's my opinion too. | <p>3. Wouldn't you agree this can give us a leg up? Janet agrees, she says...</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> a. I'd like to agree with you but I don't. b. I don't disagree with that. c. I don't really agree. |
| <p>2. Their headquarters is in Florida, but they have offices in Latin America. Miranda agrees, she says...</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> a. I can see your point now. b. I don't really agree. c. You could say that, but ... | <p>4. I believe this will give us a huge advantage. Janet disagrees, she says...</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> a. I'm sure you're right. b. That's a good point. c. You could say that, but I think there are more disadvantages than advantages. |



Let's Practice!

Before Miranda can call it a day*, she has to write something down.

*"call it a day": to say that a day's work has been completed

Instructions: Proofread the sentence. Circle the incorrect word. Correct the mistakes.

1. I need to make sure to keep Miranda out of the circle of these changes.
2. I have to development our story right away.
3. The company is based in the States. Their footquarters are located in Miami. They have a playforce made up of 10 sales people. 3 of the mass speak English, Spanish and Portuguese.
4. I need to wear at mind that we have other strenghts we can use to our advantage.





Extension Activity

I agree, but ...

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- With a partner, choose a topic to discuss. It can be a favorite movie or something that happened at work.
- Make sure to give your opinion throughout the conversation.
- Make sure to also agree and disagree when necessary.

Self-Assessment

Yes **No**

I choose a topic to discuss with a partner.

☐ ☐

I give my opinion during a conversation.

☐ ☐

I agree and disagree with statements when necessary.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **to implement** (verb): to take action on something that you have officially decided should happen
e.g. We need to implement these changes right away.
- **strategy** (noun): a planned series of actions for achieving something
e.g. We will put our strategy into use right away.
- **to be in the loop** (verb): to be aware of what's happening
e.g. I need to make sure you're in the loop.
- **headquarters** (noun): the main building or offices used by a large company
e.g. Their headquarters are located in Florida.
- **staff** (noun): the people who work for a company
e.g. Some of our staff can speak Spanish.
- **workforce** (noun): all the people who work in a particular company
e.g. They have a workforce made up of 10 people.
- **to bear in mind** (expression): to remember a fact or piece of information that is important; to consider
e.g. We need to bear in mind that we have other strengths.





Learning Points

Giving Your Opinion

In the business world, it is common to give your opinion about things. Before you give your opinion, it is advisable to introduce how you feel about something. Here are some phrases you can use when you give your opinion.

Giving Opinions

I believe ...
I reckon ...
As far as I know, ...
If you ask me, ...
Personally, ...
To my mind, ...
The way I see it, ...
To be honest/frank ...
It seems that ...

Examples:

- *To my mind, they do have an advantage over us because of their location.*
- *It seems that we have some bilingual people that could potentially help with dealing with them.*





Learning Points

Agreeing and Disagreeing

In English, when people give an opinion, it is important to show that you either agree or don't agree with it.

There are many different ways in which we can show agreement or disagreement in English. Here are some of them:

Agreeing	Disagreeing
<i>(That's a) good point.</i> <i>(That's) so true.</i> <i>I feel the same way.</i> <i>I'm sure you are right.</i> <i>That's my opinion too.</i> <i>I see what you mean.</i> <i>I can see your point now.</i> <i>I don't disagree with that.</i>	<i>Not necessarily.</i> <i>(But) don't you think that ... ?</i> <i>(But) what about ... ?</i> <i>I don't really agree.</i> <i>I used to think that (way) ... , but ...</i> <i>I'd like to agree (with you), but ...</i> <i>That doesn't really make sense (to me).</i> <i>You could say that, but ...</i>

More on the word "agree":

The chunk 'agree with' is used when you approve of something or think it is the appropriate thing to do.

→ *Our company agrees with this new policy.*

→ ~~*Our company agrees this new policy.*~~

Apart from using a noun, you can also use the chunk "agree with doing something":

→ *I don't agree with marketing this product.*

→ ~~*I don't agree marketing this product.*~~

